LEGEND OF TOYS · INTERNAL

Podium
Operations Manual

The self-serve guide to Legend of Toys' people & performance system: profiles, the org chart, observations, wins, 1:1s, OKRs, appraisals and the people-data that stays private by design.

EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Version	Updated	Application
1.8.1	2026-11-13	podium.legendoftoys.com

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PART 1

Getting Started

What Podium is, how to sign in, find your way around, and exactly what your access lets you see.

Welcome to Podium

EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Podium is the Legend of Toys people & performance system: one place for who works here, how the company is structured, the good work people do through the year, and the twice-yearly appraisal. It is the most private system we run, so almost everything you see is scoped tightly to you, your team and your role. This manual is your self-serve guide to every screen in it.

What Podium holds

Podium brings together things that used to live in spreadsheets, chat threads and people's memories:

AREA	WHAT IT COVERS
People	Every person's profile: contact details, employment, documents and (for HR) compensation history. A headcount dashboard and a searchable directory.
Org chart	The live reporting structure, who reports to whom, drawn from each person's manager. Snapshots let you keep a picture of how the org looked on a given date.
Performance	Continuous record-keeping through the year: **observations** a manager logs, **wins** people record about themselves, and **1:1** meeting notes.
Appraisals	The twice-yearly review: a self-review, a manager review, an HR calibration, the final rating shared with you, and the increment that follows.
Org design	The registry of job roles (with their job descriptions and KPIs) and the department structure everything else hangs off.

Who it is for

Everyone at Legend of Toys uses Podium, but most people use only a small corner of it:

- **Everyone** can see their own profile, record their own wins, and take part in their own appraisal.
- **Managers** additionally see their team, log observations and 1:1s, and review their team's appraisals.
- **HR and admins** run the whole thing: people, departments, roles, documents, appraisal cycles and settings.

ⓘ PRIVACY IS THE WHOLE POINT

Unlike our other systems, Podium does **not** show everything to everyone. What you can see depends on who you are, who reports to you, and the access your account has been given. The next two chapters explain exactly how that works, because it shapes every screen in this manual.

How to use this manual

Each chapter covers one screen and follows the same shape: what it is for, how to read it, and what to do. Jump to the screen you are on using the Contents page or your PDF reader's bookmarks. Chapters are tagged with the access tiers that use them:

EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Callout boxes

✓ TIP

A faster or smarter way to do something.

⚠ WATCH OUT

A common mistake or something easy to misread.

⛔ IMPORTANT

Something that affects someone's privacy, their pay or an official record: get it right.

Signing In & Getting Around

EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Podium opens with one click using your work Google account, and everything is reachable from a short sidebar grouped by what it does. This chapter covers signing in and finding your way around. What appears in your sidebar depends on your access, so two people can see different menus.

Signing in

Open `podium.legendoftoys.com` and sign in with your `@legendoftoys.com` Google account. Personal accounts are refused; if sign-in bounces you back, sign out of any personal Google account first or use a fresh browser profile. There is no separate Podium password: your Google login is your login.

> ⓘ **FIRST TIME IN?**
>
> If you sign in and Podium says you don't have an employee profile linked yet, that's normal for a brand-new joiner: ask HR to link your profile to your login. Until then you can sign in but there's nothing personal to show you.

The menu

The sidebar is grouped. You only see the groups and items your access allows:

GROUP	WHAT LIVES HERE	WHO SEES IT
PEOPLE	Dashboard, Directory, Org Chart, New Person.	Managers, HR and admins. (New Person is HR/admin only.)
PERFORMANCE	My Performance, Team, Appraisals.	My Performance is for everyone; Team for managers; Appraisals for HR/admin.
ORG DESIGN	Roles & KPIs, Departments.	Managers, HR and admins.
SYSTEM MANUAL	This manual, in the app.	Everyone.
ADMIN	Roles & Permissions, Users, Settings.	Admins only.

✓ IF YOUR SIDEBAR IS SHORT, THAT'S EXPECTED

A self-serve employee with no special access sees only **My Performance**, and Podium opens straight to it. That's by design, not a bug: you have full access to your own record and nothing about anyone else. The moment HR gives you a wider role, or someone starts reporting to you, the extra menus appear.

Getting around

Most list screens (the Directory, the appraisal grid) have a search box and clickable rows: click any row to open it. The Directory and other lists also support the arrow keys with Enter to open the highlighted row. The top of a detail screen has a **Back** button that returns you to where you came from.

Names are links almost everywhere: a person's name in the org chart, on a team feed card, or in an appraisal grid takes you to their profile (subject to what you're allowed to see).

Roles & What You Can See

EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Podium decides what you can see from two separate things: your **access tier** (set by an admin) and your **place in the org chart** (who reports to you). This chapter explains both in plain terms, because together they shape every screen in the rest of this manual.

The four access tiers

EMPLOYEE	**The default for everyone.** You can see your own profile in full, record and edit your own wins, see observations and 1:1 notes that have been shared with you, and take part in your own appraisal. You see nothing about anyone else. This is what you get with no special role assigned, and it is a real, full level of access to *your* data, not a locked-out state.
MANAGER	**Anyone with people reporting to them.** On top of the employee tier, you see the full profiles of everyone in your reporting line (your direct reports and the people under them), log observations and 1:1s for them, and review their appraisals. You do not get this from a role: Podium works it out from the org chart, so the day someone starts reporting to you, you become their manager in Podium automatically.
HR	**The People team.** Sees everyone's full profile, adds and edits people, manages departments, job roles and documents, captures org snapshots, and runs appraisal cycles. HR sees the most sensitive fields (bank details, ID proofs, PAN) that even a person's manager cannot.
ADMIN	**Full control.** Everything HR can do, plus Podium's own Roles & Permissions, assigning people to roles, and system settings (including the salary vault).

ⓘ A SEPARATE LEVEL FOR PAY

Seeing **compensation** (increments, bonuses and salary bands) is a distinct permission that an admin grants on its own. So you can be HR and manage people without seeing pay, or be given pay access without being a full admin. Wherever this manual says “if you have compensation access,” that is the permission it means.

Who sees what

AREA	EMPLOYEE	MANAGER	HR	ADMIN
Your own profile & wins, your own appraisal	•	•	•	•
Directory, org chart, dashboard		•	•	•
Full profile of your reporting line; log observations & 1:1s for them		•	•	•
Full profile of *everyone*; add/edit people; departments & roles; documents			•	•
Run appraisal cycles, calibrate, share results			•	•
Bank details, ID proofs, PAN	own		•	•
Compensation (increments, bonuses, salary bands)			only with compensation access	
Roles & Permissions, Users, Settings				•

⛔ WHAT A MANAGER CANNOT SEE

Being someone's manager lets you see their full profile, but **not** their bank details, ID proofs or PAN, and not their pay. Those stay with HR and the person themselves. This is deliberate: management visibility is not the same as HR visibility.

How your access is set

Your access comes from a **Podium role** an admin assigns to your account (on the Users screen). Podium runs its own roles, separate from every other LOT system, so being made HR in Podium does not change your access in Garage, Redline or anywhere else. If you cannot do something you believe you should, an admin needs to adjust your Podium role; your manager visibility, separately, follows the org chart.

⚠ TWO DIFFERENT THINGS, OFTEN CONFUSED

“Manager” in Podium is about the org chart (who reports to you), and it drives what profiles you can open. A “role” like HR or Admin is a separate access tier an admin grants. You can be a manager with no special role at all, and still see your team, because that visibility comes from the org chart, not the role.

PART 2

People

The headcount dashboard, the directory, individual profiles, the org chart and adding someone new.

Dashboard

`/dashboard` MANAGER HR ADMIN

The Dashboard is Podium's home screen for anyone with people access: a quick read on the size and shape of the company, who has just joined, and whose anniversary or birthday is coming up. It is a glance, not a place to change anything.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	COVERS
A snapshot of headcount and the month ahead.	Read-only.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	The whole company.

The headline tiles

A strip of tiles across the top counts people by their current status:

TILE	WHAT IT COUNTS
Headcount	Everyone currently active. This is the number people usually mean by "how many are we?"
Departments	How many departments exist.
On Leave	People marked as on leave.
Notice	People serving notice.
Exited	People who have left. They stay in Podium for the record; they just don't count in headcount.

The cards

Below the tiles, five cards break the numbers down and surface the near future:

`By Department`	Each department with its headcount, largest first. A fast read on where the people are.
`By Employment Type`	The active team split into full-time, intern, contract and so on.

Recent Joiners	The six newest active people, with their title and how long they've been here. Click any name to open their profile.
Upcoming Work Anniversaries	Anyone whose joining date anniversary falls in the next 30 days, with how many days away it is.
Upcoming Birthdays	The same, for birthdays in the next 30 days. Empty if nobody has one coming up.

ⓘ WHY A CARD MIGHT BE EMPTY

The anniversary and birthday cards rely on each person having a joining date and a date of birth on file. If a card says “None in the next 30 days,” it may genuinely be quiet, or it may mean those dates are missing on some profiles. The fix is to fill them in on the Profile screen.

✓ TIP

The anniversary and birthday cards are the easiest way to never miss a moment that matters to someone. A quick scan on a Monday morning sets up the week's shout-outs.

Directory

/people MANAGER HR ADMIN

The Directory is the searchable list of everyone at Legend of Toys. It is where you look someone up, filter by team or status, and open a profile. For HR it is also the door to adding a new person and to pulling the latest joiners and leavers from Google.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	COVERS
Finding and opening people.	Read; HR can add & sync.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Everyone, filterable.

Reading the list

Each row shows the person's **code** (their EMP number, in yellow), **name** (with a preferred name in brackets if they have one), **title**, **department**, **manager** and a **status** badge. Click any row, or use the arrow keys and Enter, to open that person's profile.

Narrowing it down

Two controls sit above the list:

- **Status tabs**: Active (the default), On Leave, Notice, Exited, or All. Most of the time Active is what you want; switch to Exited or All to find someone who has left.
- **Search and department**: the search box matches name, code, title or email; the dropdown filters to one department. Use them together to zero in.

HR actions

If you're HR or an admin, two buttons appear top-right:

1. **New Person** opens the form to create a profile from scratch. See the *New Person* chapter.
2. **Sync from Google** pulls the company's Google Workspace directory and opens the Google Directory window: new joiners and departures, and a check of Google against Podium. See the callout below and the *Google Directory Sync* chapter.

ⓘ SYNC FROM GOOGLE, IN PLAIN TERMS

The first tab, **From Google**, shows new joiners to add and people whose Google account has gone (possible leavers). **Nothing is saved until you press Apply.** Shared mailboxes and addresses on the ignore list are left out. **Bringing someone in needs their joining date** — Google only knows when the account was made, and an employee with no joining date is treated as having worked in *every* month the salary reports cover. A future date is fine. **Departures are alerts only:** the sync never exits anyone. Open the person and use Start exit, where you record the real last working day. A new joiner still needs their manager set afterwards. The second tab, **Google vs Podium**, pushes Podium's values to Google. See the *Google Directory Sync* chapter.

The sync compares Podium against the Google directory and proposes changes: new joiners to add and people who've disappeared from Google (possible leavers). **Nothing is saved until you confirm.** You tick who to bring in and who to mark as exited; shared mailboxes and accounts you've told it to ignore are left out. **Bringing someone in needs their joining date** — Google can only tell us when their account was made, which is often not when they started, and an employee with no joining date is treated as having worked in *every* month the salary reports cover. A future date is fine here: it is normal to set someone up before their first day. **When you mark someone exited you must type their real last working day** — Google only tells us their account is gone, never when they last worked, so the sync will not save an exit without a date and will not fill one in for you. That date decides the month their salary stops counting toward company overheads, so it matters that it is the true last day rather than the day you happen to be doing the tidy-up. **If you don't know it yet, leave the row unticked** and exit them once HR confirms; the row will still be waiting at the next sync. It never overwrites edits you've made by hand and never guesses a reporting line, so a new joiner still needs their manager set afterwards.

⚠ A BLANK DIRECTORY ISN'T BROKEN

If you have only self-serve access, you won't have the Directory at all; that's the access tier working as intended (see *Roles & What You Can See*). If you can open it but a filter returns nothing, check the status tab: someone you expect to find may have left and now sits under Exited.

Google Directory Sync

`/people` HR ADMIN

Podium is the source of truth for a person's core details, and it now sends them to the company Google account for you. This chapter explains what Podium writes to Google, when, who it skips, and the Directory screen (**Sync from Google**) that HR and the three Google admins use to bring in new joiners and to check Google against Podium.

WHAT IT'S FOR	DIRECTION	WHO	WHERE
Keeping Google in line with Podium.	Podium to Google, one way.	HR ADMIN (push: Google admins)	Directory → Sync from Google; a person's page.

Podium wins: the six fields

Podium owns these Google fields: **name**, **job title**, **department**, **manager**, **employee code** and **org unit**. Podium never copies them back from Google.

> ⚠ EDITING THESE IN GOOGLE IS POINTLESS
>
> If you change one of the six in Google, Podium's next change to that person overwrites it, and the Google vs Podium tab will show it as *differs*. Make the change in Podium instead. Anything not in the list (passwords, suspension, groups, the sign-in address) is never touched by Podium.

A field that is blank in Podium leaves Google's value alone. The one exception is the manager: a person with no manager in Podium has their manager removed in Google.

What happens when you save a person

When HR (or the person, on their own profile) saves a change, Podium sends **only the fields that changed** to Google, within seconds. The save itself never fails because of Google.

- **Google sync pending** (a small chip on the person's page): the update is on its way.
- **Not synced to Google** (chip): this person is skipped; hover for the reason (see below).
- **Google not updated, retry** (red banner): Google could not be reached or refused the change. The banner gives the reason and the time of the next try. Podium retries on its own after **1, 5 and 30 minutes**. A **Google admin** sees a **Retry** button to try straight away; everyone else sees the banner only.

Who is never written to Google

- **Founders** and super-admins, always, in full.
- People who have **exited**.
- Addresses on the **ignore list**.
- Anyone in an **excluded org unit** (shared and system accounts).
- People with no Google account, a suspended one, or whose work email is only an alias in Google.

Org unit on the person form

The **Google org unit** picker sits beside Department in the Role & Reporting section of the person form.

- When you change the department, the picker **suggests that department's usual org unit** (marked "usual for this department"), but only if the org unit is blank or still the old department's suggestion. One you chose yourself is never replaced.
- It **cannot pick an excluded org unit**; the list leaves them out and a save with one is refused.
- **Org units with nobody in them yet don't appear.** If you need a brand-new one, ask a Google admin to move the first person in Google.
- *Not set* means Google keeps whatever org unit the person already has.

Directory → Sync from Google

HR and admins open it from the Directory. It has two tabs.

Tab 1: From Google

Now only for three jobs: **new joiners** (create them in Podium), **departures** and the **ignore list**.

- **New people**: tick Import (joining date required) or Ignore. Department and manager can be set here for the new row.
- **Exit started outside Podium**: people active in Podium whose Google account is suspended or gone. This is an alert only; use **Start the exit here** on their page to record the exit with its reason and last working day.
- It **no longer updates departments or managers from Google**. Those differences are handled on the second tab, in Podium's favour.

Tab 2: Google vs Podium

`GOOGLE ADMINS ONLY` can push; HR can read the comparison. Every synced person and field gets a state:

- **Same**: Google already matches Podium.
- **Differs**: Google has a different value. Ticked by default.
- **Blank in Podium**: nothing to push; Google keeps its value.
- **Changed in Google**: someone edited Google after Podium last pushed it. Unticked by default, so you look before Podium's value overwrites it.

1. **Tick what you want** person by person and field by field. “Show people with no differences” widens the list.
2. **Click Preview**. It shows exactly what would be sent to Google; nothing is changed yet.
3. **Click Push to Google** and confirm. **Push only works after a Preview** of the same ticks, and sends in batches of eight people.

> ⓘ BULK PUSH IS PAUSED FOR NOW
>
> Preview still works. The **Push to Google** button is replaced by the line “Bulk push paused while Podium’s data is checked.” until the pause is lifted. Saving a person in Podium still updates that person’s Google account with the fields the save changed, so editing a title in Podium updates Google. The steps above apply once the pause is lifted.

> ⚠ STALE, AND NO AUTOMATIC RETRY
>
> If someone changes a value between Preview and Push, that person is refused as **stale** (the others in the batch still go). Preview again for them. A **failed admin push is not retried automatically**; the screen lists who was not pushed and why, and you preview and push again.

> ⓘ PHONE NUMBERS STAY IN PODIUM
>
> Podium never sends phone numbers to Google and never changes a phone number in Google.

A Person's Profile

`/people/detail` EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

A person's profile is the single page that gathers everything Podium knows about them: their employment and personal details, their team, documents, compensation history, and the running record of their performance. How much of it you see depends entirely on who you are to that person, so this is the screen where Podium's privacy rules are most visible.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	TABS
One person, everything about them.	Read; HR edits; managers log performance.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	Profile · Observations · Wins · 1:1s

Full view vs limited view

At the top, under the person's name, you may see a yellow banner reading *"Limited view, full profile is visible to HR, the person, and their managers."* That tells you you're looking at the public-facing subset (essentially their role and where they sit), not the whole profile. You get the **full** view only when the person is you, when you're in their management chain, or when you're HR or an admin.

WHAT STAYS HIDDEN, EVEN IN THE FULL VIEW

A manager seeing a report's full profile still does **not** see their bank details, ID proofs or PAN; those appear only for HR, an admin, and the person themselves. Compensation is hidden too, unless you specifically have compensation access. Visibility is not all-or-nothing: the most sensitive fields are walled off separately.

The Profile tab

The profile is a set of cards. Which ones appear depends on your view:

CARD	WHAT'S ON IT	SHOWN TO
Employment	Job role, manager, employment type, legal entity, location, joining date and tenure. The full view adds probation and confirmation dates, and exit details if they've left.	Everyone (more in the full view).
Personal	Work and personal email, phone, date of birth, gender, blood group, emergency contact, and PAN.	Full view only. PAN shows only to HR/admin and the person.

CARD	WHAT'S ON IT	SHOWN TO
Team	The people who report to this person. Click a name to jump to their profile.	Anyone, if they have reports.
Documents	Files on record (offer letters, ID, and so on), each downloadable.	Full view only.
Compensation	Increment and bonus history.	Compensation access only.

Editing (HR only)

If you're HR or an admin, an **Edit** button sits top-right. It opens the same form used to add a person (see *New Person* for the field-by-field guide). Note the employee code can never be changed; it is the person's permanent ID.

Documents

Documents are held privately: clicking **Download** fetches the file through a short-lived secure link, so the file is never sitting on a public address. HR and admins can upload new documents and delete existing ones; everyone else with the full view can only download.

> ⓘ THE SALARY VAULT
>
> On the Compensation card you'll often see a note that the **salary vault is disabled**. While it's off, Podium records only **increment percentages and one-time bonus amounts**, never absolute salary figures. "Current CTC" will read "(vault off)." This is intentional until the extra security layer is in place; see the *Settings* chapter.

The performance tabs

Three further tabs turn the profile into the person's performance record. What you can do on them depends on whether you manage this person.

Observations

Short notes a manager logs about the person's work through the year, each with a **tone** (Positive, Neutral or Constructive), a date, optional tags, and a **visibility** setting that decides who can read it:

VISIBILITY	WHO CAN READ IT
Private	Only the author and HR. The person it's about *never* sees it.
Shared with managers	The author, the person's manager chain, and HR. Still not the person.
Shared with person	The above, plus the person themselves.

Managers (and HR) log observations; you can't write one about yourself. On your own profile, or via My Performance, you see only the observations explicitly shared with you.

Wins

Accomplishments the person records about **themselves**: a title, optional detail, a date and tags. Wins are self-authored, so the place you add your own is your *My Performance* page; here you're viewing someone's wins as part of their record.

1:1s

Notes from one-to-one meetings, logged by the manager. Each has **shared notes** the report can see, an optional set of **action items** (tickable checkboxes), and **private notes** for the manager alone.

> **PRIVATE 1:1 NOTES ARE TRULY PRIVATE**
>
> The private-notes box on a 1:1 is visible only to the manager who wrote it and to HR. The report, and even skip-level managers, never see it; they see “Private manager notes hidden” instead. Use it freely for candid manager-only context, and equally, never write something in *shared* notes that you only meant for yourself.

Org Chart

/org MANAGER HR ADMIN

The Org Chart draws the company's reporting structure as a tree: who reports to whom, all the way up to the founders. It is built automatically from each person's manager, so it is always as current as the profiles behind it. You can also keep dated snapshots of how the org looked at a point in time.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SOURCE
Seeing the reporting structure.	Read; HR captures snapshots.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Each person's manager.

Reading the chart

Each person is a node; lines connect a manager to their reports. The founders sit at the top with no manager. Click any node to open that person's profile (when you're viewing the live chart).

The toolbar

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Expand all / Collapse to founders	Open the whole tree, or fold it back to just the top of the company.
Horizontal / Vertical layout	Switch between the classic top-down chart and a compact left-to-right indented tree that's easier to scan for a wide org.
People count	A live total, with a figure that excludes the founders so you can see team size at a glance.
Zoom & pan	Drag to move around and zoom to fit large charts on screen.

Snapshots

The dropdown at the top lets you switch between **Live (current)** and any saved snapshot. A snapshot is a frozen picture of the whole tree on the day it was captured, useful for "how were we structured at the last appraisal?" or for a board pack.

1. **To take one** (HR/admin), click **Capture snapshot**, give it a label, and confirm. It's saved with today's date.

2 **To view one**, pick it from the dropdown. The header shows a “snapshot” tag so you know you're not looking at the live chart.

⚠ SNAPSHOTS ARE READ-ONLY HISTORY

While you're viewing a snapshot, clicking a node won't open a profile; it's a historical record, not the live org. Switch back to **Live (current)** to navigate to people again. A snapshot also never changes after capture, so it stays a faithful record even as the live org moves on.

✓ IF SOMEONE'S IN THE WRONG PLACE

The chart is only ever as right as the profiles. If a person hangs under the wrong manager, the fix isn't here; it's on their profile, where HR sets their manager. Change it there and the chart redraws itself.

New Person

`/people/new` HR ADMIN

New Person is the form HR uses to add someone to Podium. It's the same form you reach by clicking Edit on an existing profile, so once you know it you know both. It's grouped into sections so you can fill in what you have now and come back for the rest.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	REQUIRED
Adding a person (or editing one).	Act: creates a profile.	HR ADMIN	Full name. Everything else optional.

The sections

Identity	Full name (the only required field), preferred name, work and personal email, phone, date of birth, gender, blood group, PAN and a photo URL. Date of birth feeds the birthday reminders on the Dashboard.
Role & Reporting	Job title, department, job role (from the registry), manager, employment type, legal entity and work location. The **manager** you pick here is what places the person on the org chart.
Lifecycle	Joining date, probation end, confirmation date and status. Setting the status to **Exited** reveals a last working day and an exit reason. **The last working day is required** and must be their real final day, not the day you are updating the record — it decides the month their salary stops counting toward company overheads. Saving without it is rejected. Joining date feeds tenure and work-anniversary reminders.
Emergency Contact	A name and phone for emergencies.

Adding someone

1. **Enter at least the full name.** You can save with just that and enrich the profile later.
2. **Fill in role and reporting.** Setting the manager now means the person appears on the org chart straight away.
3. **Add lifecycle dates.** The joining date is worth getting in early; tenure, anniversaries and appraisal eligibility all hang off it.

4 **Click Create person.** Podium assigns a permanent employee code (an EMP number) automatically; you don't set it and it can never be changed.

ⓘ LOGINS ARE LINKED SEPARATELY

Creating a profile does not, by itself, give someone a Podium login. A person can have a full profile, an org-chart spot, documents and compensation history without ever signing in; that's how we keep records for floor and contract staff who don't have a company Google account. Self-serve sign-in only works once their profile is linked to their `@legendoftoys.com` account, which usually happens automatically when you sync from Google or link them by email.

✓ ALREADY IN GOOGLE? SYNC INSTEAD

If the new joiner already has a company Google account, the fastest route is **Sync from Google** on the Directory: it proposes them as a new joiner with their department and login pre-matched, so you confirm rather than retype. Use this form for people who aren't in Google, or to fill in the details sync can't know.

PART 3

Hiring

Openings, candidates, bulk CV import, offer letters, the candidate's offer link, and confirming someone has joined.

Openings

`/hiring/openings` MANAGER HR ADMIN

An Opening is one open seat (or several identical seats) that Legend of Toys wants to fill. Everything in hiring hangs off an opening: its job description (JD), its approved salary band, the people who run it, and the candidates who apply. You make one here before you can add a single CV.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	NEEDS FIRST
Creating and tracking openings.	Act: create, edit, open, hold, close.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	A JD, before any candidate.

Finding an opening

Open **Hiring → Openings** (`/hiring/openings`). The chips along the top filter by status: **Live** (the default: Draft, Open and On Hold together), Open, Draft, On Hold, Filled, Cancelled and All. The search box matches the opening's name. Each row shows the opening and its code, the department, the reporting manager, a status badge, whether the **JD** is in ("JD ✓" or "JD needed"), the salary **Band** status, **Candidates** (active over total) and **Seats**. Click a row to open it.

You see the openings you run, the ones you manage, the ones you are the approver on, plus everything if you hold the Hiring permission or are HR. Anyone else sees an empty list.

To create an opening

You can create one if you hold the **Hiring** permission or manage people. Press **New opening** (top right of the list) and fill four cards:

1. **Role.** Pick a **Job role** from the registry if one fits (it prefills the designation and department), or just type the **Designation** (required). Choose the **Department**, the **Type** (Full-time or Intern), the **Headcount** (how many identical seats, 1 to 100), the city and state, an optional target join date and notes.
2. **Team.** The **Reporting manager** (required) defaults to you. The **Hiring owner** is the person who runs the opening day to day and whose mailbox the offer email is sent from. It is you unless you hold the Hiring permission, in which case you can name someone else.
3. **Salary band.** Enter the **Band min** and **Band max** as annual total CTC in rupees (for example ₹X to ₹Y). If you are on the salary allow-list you can instead tick **Use the role's band** to copy the band already set on the job role.

4 **Job description.** Choose **Later**, **Paste** text, **Upload** a PDF or Word file, or **Role's JD** (copies the job role's current JD). Then press **Create opening**.

> ⚠ NO JD, NO CANDIDATES
>
> An opening with no JD stays a **Draft**, and no CVs or candidates can be added to it. Choosing "Later" is allowed, but the opening shows a "JD needed" badge until someone adds one. Add it on the opening's page with **Add JD**; later edits use **New version**, and every earlier version stays in the version history.

The salary band: requested, then approved

Creating the opening does not approve the band. It **sends the band for approval**, and the screen tells you so ("Opening created, band sent for approval"). The approver is fixed at that moment (a snapshot): it is the **reporting manager's manager**, or a founder when the reporting manager is a founder or has no manager above them.

- The approver sees **Approve** and **Reject** on the opening's *Salary band* card and is asked for a note. Nobody else sees those buttons.
- **Nobody approves their own request.** If you asked for the band, someone else has to decide it. If you try to put yourself on an opening's approval chain, Podium refuses and tells you to ask a founder.
- To change a band later press **Request change**, enter the new min and max, and **Send for approval**. It replaces any pending request. Earlier versions stay listed with their outcome (Approved, Rejected, Superseded).
- Changing the reporting manager re-sends a pending band to the new approver.

An **approved band is required before an offer can be made**. The band numbers are visible only to the opening's own chain and the salary allow-list; everyone else sees "hidden".

Running the opening

The buttons at the top of an opening depend on its status and on whether you are the hiring owner or hold the Hiring permission:

`Open`	Available on a Draft or On Hold opening **that has a JD**. Candidates can be added only while it is Open.
`Hold`	Pauses an Open opening. You are asked why.
`Mark filled`	Closes the opening as Filled. Joining someone (see *Joining*) also fills it automatically once the headcount is reached.
`Cancel`	Closes it as Cancelled; you are asked why.

Reopen	Only with the Hiring permission, on a Filled or Cancelled opening. It returns to Open, or to On Hold if it has no JD.

> ⓘ **CLOSE THE CANDIDATES FIRST**
>
> You cannot mark an opening Filled or Cancelled while candidates are still active on it. Close or move each of them first (see *Candidates & Pipeline*).

The **Team** card holds the hiring owner, the reporting manager and the band approver, with **Edit** for the details. Changing the reporting manager or hiring owner needs the Hiring permission. The **Interview rounds** card holds the opening's round plan: an ordered list of rounds, each with a name, default interviewers and a scorecard of up to 10 criteria (each scored 1 to 5). The hiring owner and anyone with the Hiring permission can **Add round**, edit, reorder with the arrows, and **Deactivate** a round (a round is never deleted, so past interviews keep their record). Changes apply only to interviews scheduled afterwards; see *Interviews*. Each candidate row on the opening also shows how many interviews they have, the next one, and how much feedback is owed. The **Candidates** card and a **Timeline** of everything that happened sit below.

Candidates & Pipeline

`/hiring` MANAGER HR ADMIN

Candidates is the list of everyone who has applied to any opening you can see. It keeps one record per person, however many openings they apply to, and tracks where each application stands.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	ADDED FROM
The candidate list and each person's file.	Both: add, edit, move, upload.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	An opening, never from this list.

Candidate versus application

Two ideas keep this tidy:

- A **candidate** is the person: name, contact, employer, skills, documents. They get one code (CAND-) and one file, forever.
- An **application** is that person on one opening. The **status** (New, Screening, Interviewing and so on) belongs to the application, so the same person can be Rejected for one role and Interviewing for another.

The list

Open **Hiring → Candidates** (`/hiring`). Status chips filter by the latest application's status (All, New, Screening, Interviewing, On Hold, Rejected, Withdrawn); the opening dropdown narrows to one opening; the search box matches name, email or phone. Each row shows the candidate, contact, current title and location, the latest opening and its status. The buttons top right are **Openings** and **Import CVs**. A reminder under the filters says candidates are added from an opening, because the JD comes first.

To add one candidate

1. **Go to the opening** (*Openings*, then the row). Its **Candidates** card has an **Add candidate** button. It is greyed out, with the reason beside it, when the opening has no JD or is not Open.
2. **Fill the form.** Only the full name is required. There are fields for email, phone, current employer and title, experience in years, location, LinkedIn, notice period in days and notes. Pick the **Source** (Referral, LinkedIn, Naukri, Campus, Walk-in, Agency, Careers page, Other); a referral asks who referred them; **Source detail** takes an agency or campus name. **Current CTC** and **Expected CTC** appear only if you can see salary on this opening.

3. **Watch for duplicates** as you tab out of the email and phone boxes (below).
4. **Press Add candidate.** Podium offers to open their profile so you can upload the CV straight away.

To add many at once from CV files, use *Import CVs* instead.

Duplicates

When an email or phone matches someone already in Podium, a yellow box lists them with their code, contact details and number of applications. Use **View** to look, or **Add to opening** to put the existing person on this opening instead of creating a second record. If the match is someone on an opening you cannot see, you only learn that one exists ("Ask HR before creating a new record"). A person who already has an active application on the same opening cannot be added to it twice.

The candidate's page

Click a row to open `/hiring/detail`. It has these parts:

`Profile`	Contact, employer, title, experience, skills, education, LinkedIn and notes. **Edit** changes them for everyone; the candidate is one record across all openings.
`Documents`	Pick a **Type** (CV, Education, Experience letter, Photo, Other; plus Payslip, Signed offer and Offer as sent for the salary chain; ID proof, PAN, Address proof, Bank details and Relieving letter for HR only), optionally the application it belongs to and a title, choose a file and press **Upload**. PDF, Word or an image, up to 15 MB. You only see the types your access allows. HR can delete any document; the person who uploaded one can delete it within 24 hours. A document that backs an offer cannot be deleted.
`Applications`	One row per opening, with its status, source, notice period and (if you can see salary) current and expected CTC. This is where you move a candidate along.
`Interviews`	Under each application, an **Interviews** block to schedule rounds, see each panelist's feedback status, and record verdicts. See *Interviews*.
`Timeline`	Everything that happened, in order.

Statuses and moving a candidate

On an application, the **Move to…** dropdown offers only the moves that make sense from the current status:

From	You can move to

New	Screening, Rejected, Withdrawn, On Hold
Screening	Interviewing, Rejected, Withdrawn, On Hold
Interviewing	Rejected, Withdrawn, On Hold (and an offer can be made from here)
On Hold	New, Screening, Interviewing, Rejected, Withdrawn
Offer	Declined, Withdrawn, Rejected (close the live offer first)
Accepted	Withdrawn, No Show

Scheduling an interview moves a New or Screening candidate to Interviewing automatically, so you rarely need the dropdown for that step (see *Interviews*). The reverse also holds: **closing a candidate** (Rejected, Withdrawn, Declined, No Show or Joined) **cancels their scheduled interviews**.

Offer, Accepted and Joined cannot be picked by hand. They happen when an offer is sent, when acceptance is recorded, and when joining is confirmed (see *Offers* and *Joining*). Rejected, Withdrawn and Declined ask you to pick a **reason** (Not a fit, Skills, Experience, Compensation, Location, Notice period, Candidate withdrew, No response, Duplicate, Other). The reason is visible to everyone who sees the application; the optional free-text note beside it is visible only to the opening's salary chain.

The small arrows icon (**Move to another opening**) closes the application as withdrawn and starts a new one at New on another open opening. You must give a reason, and **salary fields are not copied**. **Edit** on an application changes its source, referrer, notice period and CTC.

> ⓘ **WHAT YOU CAN SEE DEPENDS ON YOUR SEAT**
>
> The worker decides, per opening, who can see a candidate and who can see pay. If a candidate's page says “Not found, or you don't have access”, you are not on that opening's chain. Ask the hiring owner or HR.

Interviews

/hiring/interviews EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Interviews are how a candidate moves from a screened CV to a decision. The hiring team schedules each round, the interviewers score the candidate on a scorecard after they meet, and the team records a verdict. Interviewers are ordinary employees: they get a small, separate screen called My interviews and see only what they need to judge the candidate.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	WHERE
Rounds, scheduling, scorecard feedback and verdicts.	Act: schedule, give feedback, decide.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	A candidate's page, an opening, and My interviews.

Who does what

Who	What they can do
The opening's hiring owner, its reporting manager, anyone with the Hiring permission	Schedule, edit, cancel and no-show interviews; record the verdict; send reminders.
The hiring owner and anyone with the Hiring permission	Also edit the opening's round plan (the *Interview rounds* card).
Any active employee with a Podium login	Can be put on a panel as an interviewer. They give feedback in **My interviews**.

Being an interviewer gives no extra access to openings, candidates or offers. It opens only the one interview you are on. Seeing an opening (as HR or an approver, for example) does not let you schedule on it.

Rounds and scorecards

An opening can have a **round plan**: an ordered list such as Technical, Culture, Founder. Each round has a name, optional **default interviewers** (pre-filled when you schedule it) and a **scorecard** of up to 10 criteria, each scored 1 to 5. Set this up on the opening's **Interview rounds** card (see *Openings*).

> ⓘ CHANGES APPLY FROM NOW ON
>
> Each interview keeps a copy of the scorecard it was scheduled with. Editing a round later changes only interviews scheduled afterwards.

An opening with no round plan can still hold interviews: you type a round name when you schedule, and there is no scorecard (only the overall rating and recommendation).

Scheduling an interview

Open the candidate's page (`/hiring/detail`). Each application has an **Interviews** block with a **Schedule interview** button.

1. **Pick the round** from the plan, or type a round name if the opening has no plan.
2. **Set the date and time.** Times are entered and shown in **IST**, whatever your computer's clock says. You may pick a time up to 30 days back (to record an interview that already happened) and up to a year ahead.
3. **Set duration and mode.** Duration is 30 to 120 minutes in steps (any length from 10 minutes to 8 hours is accepted). Mode is In person, Video or Phone; the last box takes a room, a meeting link, or who calls whom.
4. **Choose the panel** (1 to 10 interviewers). It is pre-filled from the round's defaults. You may include yourself when scheduling.
5. **Press Schedule.**

- The opening must have a **JD** and be **Open**, and the candidate must be New, Screening or Interviewing. Otherwise the button is hidden or Podium says why. The interview records which JD version it ran against.
- Scheduling for a **New or Screening** candidate moves them to **Interviewing** at the same moment, and the timeline records it.
- A candidate can have only one live interview per round. A cancelled or no-show round can be scheduled again.
- Feedback is due **24 hours after** the interview time.

Editing the interview and its panel

The pencil on a scheduled interview changes the time, duration, mode, place and panel.

- **You cannot add or remove yourself** on an existing panel. Joining after feedback is in would let you read it; leaving would let you dodge it. Ask another member of the hiring team.
- A panelist who has **already submitted** feedback cannot be removed.
- Once **any feedback is in, the time cannot move**. Cancel the interview and schedule a new one instead.
- Moving the time before any feedback moves the pending due dates to 24 hours after the new time.

My interviews (for interviewers)

Open **Hiring → My interviews** (`/hiring/interviews`). It appears for anyone on the panel of a live interview, and for a pure interviewer it is the only hiring item they see. Three tabs, each with a count:

- **Feedback owed**: interviews whose time has passed and where you have not submitted. An **overdue** count shows beside it (and on the menu item) once the 24 hours are up. This tab opens first when

you owe anything.

- **Upcoming**: interviews still to come, soonest first.
- **Done**: feedback you have submitted, and interviews that need nothing from you (for example a no-show, or a candidate whose application has since closed).

Click a row to open the interview (`/hiring/interviews/detail`). If an interview is cancelled you lose access to it.

What an interviewer sees, and does not

Sees	Never sees
Name, code, current employer and title, experience, skills, education, location, LinkedIn. The opening's code, designation and department. The JD the interview ran against. The round and scorecard. The candidate's **CV, education and experience documents**.	Salary or expected pay, email or phone, the hiring team's notes, offers, the timeline, other applications, other document types.

Giving feedback

You can submit only **after the interview time has passed**. Until then the page shows the scorecard but no form. The form needs:

- a score of 1 to 5 for **every** scorecard criterion;
- an **overall rating** of 1 to 5;
- a **recommendation**: Strong yes, Yes, No or Strong no;
- notes (optional, up to 5,000 characters).

> ⚠ SUBMIT ONCE, AND IT IS BLIND
>
> Podium asks you to confirm, and feedback **cannot be edited afterwards**. There are no drafts. You see the other interviewers' feedback only **after you submit your own**. This holds even if you are also the hiring owner or reporting manager: while you are on the panel and have not submitted, the candidate's page tells you your colleagues' feedback is hidden. A hiring-team member who is *not* on the panel sees every submitted feedback.

On the candidate's page each panelist shows **Upcoming**, **Pending**, **Overdue** or **Submitted**. Pending rows never show content.

Reminding an interviewer

Next to each panelist whose feedback is owed, the hiring team sees **Remind**. It emails the interviewer from **your own work mailbox**, naming the candidate *code*, the round and the time, with a link to My interviews. It carries no candidate name or contact details and no feedback. You can send one per interviewer every 12 hours; the row then shows how many times they have been reminded. You need an active work mailbox, and the interviewer needs a work email.

There are **no automatic reminders yet**. Overdue feedback is shown in the app only, so chase it with Remind.

The verdict

Once an interview's time has passed, the hiring team presses **Verdict** and chooses one outcome, once per interview. Podium warns if some panelists have not submitted, but does not block you.

Verdict	What happens to the candidate
Advance	Nothing changes. Schedule the next round, or start an offer.
Hold	Moves to **On Hold**.
Reject	Needs a **reason** from the usual list, and moves to **Rejected**.

The optional note is seen only by the opening's salary chain. A reject or hold follows the normal move rules, so a candidate with a **live offer** cannot be moved until the offer is withdrawn or closed first (see *Offers*).

Cancel and no-show

- **Cancel** works on a scheduled interview and asks for a reason. **Only the opening's salary chain sees the reason.** The panel loses access.
- **No-show** appears once the interview time has passed and the candidate did not come. The candidate stays where they are, no feedback is needed, and the round can be **scheduled again**.
- **Closing a candidate cancels their scheduled interviews automatically.** When an application becomes Rejected, Withdrawn, Declined, No Show or Joined, by any route, its still-scheduled interviews are cancelled with the reason "application closed", and nothing remains owed on My interviews.

Google Calendar

Podium can put an interview on Google Calendar for you in one click and keep the invites in step with the interview. An **admin switches this on**. Until then nothing about Calendar appears anywhere, and interviews work exactly as described above.

When you schedule

For an interview in the future, the Schedule dialog shows two tick boxes:

- **Add to my Google Calendar and invite the interviewers**: on by default. For a video interview it adds a Meet link.
- **Send the candidate a separate invite (time and joining details only)**: on when the candidate has an email. If they have none, the box says so and stays off.

You, the person scheduling, are the **organiser**: the event sits on your own calendar. Interviewers get an invite with a link to the interview in Podium, and a Meet link for video interviews. Guests cannot edit the event or invite anyone else.

⚠ WHAT THE CANDIDATE SEES

The candidate's invite is separate and carries only the role, the company, the time, and the Meet link or the place. It has **no Podium link, no interviewer names and no round name**, and candidates cannot see other guests.

Interviews already scheduled

An interview scheduled before Calendar was on, or one where you left the box off, shows **Add to calendar** on its row (future interviews only). It adds the event to your calendar, with the same candidate invite choice.

Keeping Calendar and Podium in step

- **Edit in Podium** (time, duration, mode, place, panel): the invites update.
- **Cancel in Podium**: the invites are removed and the guests are told.
- **An application closing** (reject, move out, no-show) removes the invites of its cancelled interviews.
- **Someone moves the event in Google Calendar**: Podium picks up the new time the next time the candidate's page is opened, and any pending feedback due dates move with it. If feedback is already in, the time cannot move, so Podium keeps its time and moves Calendar back.
- **Someone deletes the event in Google Calendar** before the interview: Podium cancels the interview too. Deleting it after the interview has happened changes nothing in Podium.
- Changes to the guest list made in Calendar are not copied into Podium; change the panel in Podium.

On the interview row

You see	It means
On calendar · candidate invited	The event exists, and the candidate has their separate invite.
Meet	The video link for the interview.
Add to calendar	Not on a calendar yet. Opens the dialog described above.
Retry calendar	The first attempt failed. Press to try again.
Retry candidate invite	The interviewers' event went through but the candidate's did not.
Retry sync	A later change did not reach Calendar. Press to push it again.
Calendar: … (under the interview)	The reason Google gave. The interview itself is always saved; only the invite failed.

For interviewers

Interviewers see **Join** (or **Join Meet** on the interview page) next to a video interview in My interviews and on the interview page. They get no Calendar controls.

ⓘ NOT BUILT YET

Automatic reminders, feedback drafts and editing submitted feedback do not exist. Edits to the guest list in Google Calendar are not pulled into Podium.

Import CVs

`/hiring/import` MANAGER HR ADMIN

Import CVs turns a folder of resumes into candidates in minutes. You drop the files in, AI reads each one and fills in the details, and you check every row before it counts. **Nobody is added to Podium until you press Accept.**

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	LIMITS
Bulk-adding candidates from CV files.	Act: you review, then accept.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	100 CVs per batch, 15 MB each.

To import a batch

1. **Open Import CVs.** Go to **Hiring → Candidates** and press **Import CVs** (`/hiring/import`). It lists your earlier batches; the *New batch* card is at the top.
2. **Pick the opening and the source.** The opening must be **Open and have a JD**, and you must be able to add candidates to it. Choose a **Source** (LinkedIn, Naukri, Campus, Walk-in, Agency, Careers page or Other) and, if you like, a **Detail** such as the job post. Referral is not offered here because it needs a named person. Press **Start batch**.
3. **Drop the files.** On the batch page (`/hiring/import/batch`) drag up to **100 CVs** onto *Add CVs*, or click it to choose. PDF, Word or image files, **up to 15 MB each**. Any file that is too big or fails to upload is listed under "Not uploaded" with the reason.
4. **Wait for the reading.** Files upload and are read a few at a time. Each row moves from *Waiting* to *Reading…* to *Check & accept*. You can leave and come back: reopening the batch picks up whatever was not read yet.
5. **Review each row** and decide (next section).

Reviewing the grid

The tabs are **To review**, **Reading**, **Accepted**, **Skipped** and **All**, each with a count. Every CV in To review is a card: a status badge, the CV's file name (press it to open the original), any warnings, then editable fields: name, email, phone, location, current employer and title, experience, notice days, education, LinkedIn and skills. Fix anything that is wrong. Under experience, notice period and CTC, the exact sentence from the CV that supports the value is shown in italics so you can check it at a glance.

The buttons on each card:

`Accept as new candidate`	Creates the candidate, puts them on the opening at status New and files the CV on their profile.
`Attach to existing`	Shown when Podium already has a match. Pick the person in the dropdown and press **Attach**: they get a new application on this opening and the CV, and their existing profile is left untouched.
`Save`	Keeps your edits without accepting, and re-checks for duplicates.
`Skip`	Sets the CV aside. Nothing is created.

Above the grid, **Accept N clean** accepts every row that has a name, **no warnings and no duplicate of any kind**, in one go. It never forces through a duplicate. **Discard batch** deletes every CV in the batch that has not been accepted (it asks first); candidates you already accepted stay.

When a row says “Enter by hand”

Some CVs cannot be read by AI. The row is marked **Enter by hand**, says why, and you type the fields yourself and Accept as normal. The reasons are:

- the file is an old **.doc** Word file, which cannot be read (save it as .docx or PDF, or type it in);
- AI reading is **switched off** or not set up;
- this month's **AI cap has been reached** (see the spend line below);
- a **scanned or photographed CV over 5 MB**;
- the read failed.

Warnings you should believe

- **Unsupported values are dropped.** Podium only keeps experience, notice period and CTC if the AI can quote the sentence from the CV that says it, and an email or phone only if it really appears in the CV. A field with no supporting quote is left blank and the row shows a warning, so you never accept a number the AI made up.
- **Scans and photos** cannot be checked that way, so the row is flagged to **check every field by hand**. They are labelled “read from scan” or “read from image”.
- **Duplicates** show in three ways: *Already in Podium* (with links to the person); *Looks like the same person as another CV in this batch* (same file, email or phone); and *someone with this email or phone is already in Podium on an opening you can't see*, which means you should check with HR before accepting. If you try to create a new candidate despite a match, Podium asks once to confirm.

Pay figures

Current CTC and **Expected CTC** fields appear only for people who can see salary on that opening. If you cannot see them, they are never shown or saved from your import.

The AI spend line

The top right shows **“AI this month: ₹x of ₹2,000 · n reads”**: what AI reading has cost so far this month against the monthly cap (resets each month, India time). If it reads “AI reading is switched off” or “AI reading not set up”, every CV goes to manual entry. The CV text is sent to OpenAI to be read and is not stored there. A super admin can change the AI model and the monthly cap.

> ⓘ BATCHES CLEAN THEMSELVES UP
>
> A batch you have not touched for **7 days** is cleared: the unaccepted CV files and rows are deleted. Accepted candidates, and the CVs already filed on their profiles, stay. If the opening is closed or put on hold while you work, you can still read CVs but cannot accept until it is Open again.

Offers

`/hiring/offer` MANAGER HR ADMIN

Offers is where a candidate's terms become a formal offer letter. Podium builds the letter and its salary breakdown (the annexure) from a template and the statutory rules, checks the terms against the opening's approved band, gets any needed approval, and freezes the result as a PDF.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	NEEDS FIRST
Drafting, approving and issuing offers.	Act.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	An approved band on the opening.

ⓘ **WHO SEES THE FIGURES**

The salary, the letter and the PDF are visible only to the opening's hiring owner, reporting manager and approver, and to the salary allow-list. Someone with only the Hiring permission sees an offer's status but no figures. Each view of an offer's figures is logged.

To make an offer

1. **Start from the candidate.** On the candidate's page, find the application. Once it is at **Interviewing** (and the opening is Open and has an approved band), its *Offers* box shows **Create offer**. If the opening has no approved band the form says so, and nothing can be created.
2. **Choose the letter. Offer of Employment** is the standard letter; **Internship Offer** is for interns.
3. **Enter the terms.** For employment: **Fixed salary, annual** (₹X), optional **Variable, annual** (called Variable pay or Incentive pay, paid Half-yearly or Monthly), and optional **Joining bonus** and **Retention bonus**. For an internship: **Stipend / month** and **Months** (1 to 24). Then the designation, department, location, **Start date** (on or before), probation in months, **Signed by** (an authorised signatory) and **Valid for (days)** (default 7).
4. **Read the live preview.** As you type, the letter and the annexure appear on the right, exactly as they will print.
5. **Save draft or Submit. Save draft** keeps it. **Submit** checks it and either issues it or sends it for approval.

The statutory calculator

The annexure splits the fixed salary into its components and works out provident fund, professional tax and ESI under the statutory rules in force **on the start date**, ending with an estimated monthly in-hand. Podium stops you from entering terms that break a rule:

- **Basic may not fall below 50% of fixed pay.**
- **Not opting in to PF** is allowed only when Basic is above the PF wage ceiling, and needs a reason.
- If deductions would push the special allowance below zero, it is refused.
- A warning appears under the band box when a state has no professional-tax rule (PT then shows as 0).

Interns are paid a stipend, with no PF, PT or variable by default; the annexure shows the monthly stipend and the total.

The band check and approval

The **Band** box compares the offer's total CTC and any one-time bonuses with the opening's approved band and shows one of: **In band**, **Below band** (allowed, flagged), **Above band, needs approval**, or **One-time extras, need approval**. Inside the band with no bonus, Submit issues the PDF straight away. Otherwise it goes to the opening's approver (named on the screen), who sees **Approve / reject** on the offer and gives an optional note. The approver is never the person who submitted it. If it is approved but the PDF was not issued, press **Issue PDF**.

The offer's life

Status	Meaning
Draft	Being written; **Edit** or **Submit**.
Pending approval / Approved / Approval rejected	Outside the band or with bonuses. A rejected one can be edited and resubmitted.
Ready to send	The PDF is issued and frozen; the terms can no longer change.
Sent	The candidate has been given the offer. The application moves to *Offer*.
Accepted	The application moves to *Accepted*.
Declined, Expired, Withdrawn, Superseded	Closed outcomes. Superseded means a newer revision replaced it.

From **Ready to send** you have two ways to deliver it. **Send by email** emails the candidate a link (see *Offer Link*). **Mark as sent** is for when you emailed the downloaded PDF yourself: enter who it went to, when (blank means now), the CC list and, optionally, the sent email printed to PDF as evidence. Podium records it and does not email anyone. Once sent, **Record acceptance** takes the acceptance date and the **signed copy (PDF)**; **Record decline** notes a decline (the application stays at Offer until you close it from the candidate page). **Download PDF** always serves the issued file, never a fresh rebuild, and its fingerprint is shown.

Revising and withdrawing

An issued offer is never edited. Press **Revise** (or **Amend** on an accepted one) to start a new draft from its terms; the reference (for example OFR-2026-001) stays and the revision number goes up (r2, r3). Sending a new revision replaces the old one. **Withdraw** cancels a live offer and needs a reason. An offer past its **Valid until** date becomes Expired; an acceptance after that needs a fresh revision.

Templates and signatories

The salary allow-list and Podium admins manage the letters at **Admin → Offer Templates** (`/admin/offer-templates`): one editor each for the standard and the intern letter, the authorised signatories, and a read-only list of the statutory rule sets. **Saving a template creates a new version**; offers already issued keep the version they used. **Preview** shows the result before you save.

Offer Link

`/offer` MANAGER HR ADMIN

Instead of attaching a PDF and waiting, Podium can email the candidate a private link. They read the offer on their phone, accept, decline or ask a question, and then upload their joining documents and bank details, all without an account. This chapter covers what you press and what the candidate sees.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	CANDIDATE PAGE
Sending the offer and handling the reply.	Act.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	`/offer`, no login.

To send the offer by email

1. **Open the offer** when it is **Ready to send** and press **Send by email**.
2. **Check the addresses. To** is prefilled with the candidate's email. **CC** is prefilled with HR, the opening's chain and the company owner; edit it freely.
3. **Press Send email.** The issued PDF and a link to view and respond are sent.

The email goes out **from the hiring owner's own Google mailbox** (the reporting manager's if the owner has none), so it looks personal and replies come back to them. It cannot be sent from anyone else's mailbox; if the sender has no work mailbox Podium refuses. Later revisions, the confirmation and any alerts reply in the **same email thread** with the same subject ("Offer, designation, Legend of Toys"). The **Emails** card on the offer lists each one with its status (sent, failed, checking…) and whether the link is *live* or *closed*. If Gmail does not answer, Podium double-checks the mailbox before it says whether the mail went.

Resend link (same revision) sends a fresh link for the same offer (for example, to a corrected address). The older links stop working.

What the candidate sees

The link opens a mobile-friendly page under the Legend of Toys logo. What it shows depends on the offer:

`Respond`	While the offer is Sent and in date: a greeting, the role, **Start date**, **Valid until** and reference, a button to open the PDF, the letter and the annexure. Three tabs follow. **Accept**: type their full name exactly as on the offer, tick "I will join on [date]" and "I have read and accept this offer", then **Accept offer**. **Decline**: pick a reason (Compensation, The role, Location, I accepted another offer, Personal reasons, Other), add a note if they wish and confirm. **I have a question**: type it and, optionally, a different joining date to discuss; it is sent to the hiring owner and the offer does not change.
`Documents`	After accepting: "Your acceptance is recorded" and a confirmation email. The page lists the **joining documents**: PAN card, ID proof, address proof, passport-size photo and cancelled cheque are required (marked *); latest payslip, relieving letter, education certificate and experience letter are optional. Each has **Upload** (or **Add another**); PDF, JPG or PNG up to 10 MB. Below it, **Bank details for salary**: name on the account, bank, account number (entered twice) and IFSC, then **Save bank details**. The page stays open until a week after the start date.
`Notice`	A plain message and nothing else when the offer is no longer actionable: replaced by a newer one ("check your latest email"), expired, withdrawn or declined ("contact [hiring owner]"), or the link is dead ("This link is no longer valid"). A notice shows no letter, name or figures.

If accepting would take the opening past its headcount, the candidate sees "Thank you, we'll be in touch shortly" and the hiring owner is alerted instead of the acceptance going through.

What you see afterwards

On the offer page, cards appear as the candidate acts:

- **Candidate responses**: declines and questions, with their reason, text and any proposed joining date. Press **Mark seen** once handled; reply to a question by email.
- **Acceptance evidence**: the typed name, time, confirmed joining date and the device details recorded at acceptance.
- **Joining documents**: a tick for each document received. HR presses **Verify** (or **Unverify**) per file after checking it.
- **Bank details**: shown masked. Only the salary allow-list can press **Reveal** to see the full number, and each reveal is logged.
- **Resend confirmation** appears if the confirmation email to the candidate did not go.

Changing bank details

Once the candidate saves their bank details they are **locked**, and the page tells them to ask Legend of Toys to reopen it. HR presses **Allow update** on the Bank details card; the candidate may then change them **once**, within 7 days.

Revisions kill the old link

Each revision has its own link. When you send a new revision, the previous offer is replaced and **its link stops working** (it shows the “replaced” notice). Only the newest link for an offer is live.

> ⚠ CHECK THE ADDRESS BEFORE YOU PRESS SEND
>
> Anyone holding the link can act on the offer, so it is protected only by being private and hard to guess. Each link also has limits (30 uploads, 10 questions a day, 5 bank saves). If it went to the wrong address, use **Resend link** to the right one, which closes the old link.

Joining

HR ADMIN

Joining turns an accepted candidate into an employee. It happens in two deliberate steps, so an employee record never exists for someone who then fails to turn up: first the Google work account is created, then, on the day they actually start, HR confirms they have joined.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	WHERE
Work account, then confirm joining.	Act.	HR ADMIN	The *Work account* box on the candidate's application.

Step 1: create the work account

Once the offer is **Accepted**, the candidate's application shows a **Work account** box. Only a **Google admin** can create the account; anyone else sees a note saying so.

1. **Check the names.** Given name and family name are prefilled (each up to 60 characters).
2. **Pick the address.** Podium proposes addresses at the company domain and marks each *available* or *taken*. Choose one, or choose **Custom**, type the part before the @ (lowercase letters, digits and dots) and press **Check**.
3. **Pick the org unit** and press **Create account**, then confirm.
4. **Note the password.** A box shows the new address and a **temporary password, once**. Press **Copy**, pass it to the person safely and press **I've noted it**. Podium never keeps it; they must change it at first sign-in.

The box then shows the address, its org unit and who created it. A Google admin can press **Reset temp password** for as long as the person has not joined. If creation fails or is interrupted, the box says so; press create again and Podium finishes the job without making a duplicate.

Step 2: confirm joining

On the person's first day, set the **Start date** (the actual date; it cannot be more than 7 days ahead or before the offer was accepted) and press **Confirm joining**. Confirm the prompt. In one step Podium:

- creates the **employee record** with a permanent EMP code and the joining date;
- copies the hiring documents (verified joining documents, bank details) onto the employee, and records the starting compensation;
- sets the application to **Joined**, and the opening to **Filled** once its headcount is reached;

- starts their **onboarding** (see *Onboarding*); if that step fails you are told to start it from the Onboarding page.

The box then links to the new employee. If the opening is full but other candidates are still active on it, a note asks you to close or move them and mark the opening Filled.

If they do not turn up

Press **Mark no-show** (with an optional note only the salary chain sees). The application becomes **No Show** and no employee is ever created. If a work account exists, a Google admin sees **Suspend account**; nothing is suspended automatically. The same button appears for a withdrawn candidate who already has an account.

> ⓘ REHIRES AND ACCOUNT-ONLY REQUESTS
>
> A person who was an employee before is not supported yet: the box tells you to handle their account and record by hand. For someone who is not coming through an opening at all, Google admins have **People → Create account without hiring**. It needs a reason of at least 10 characters and creates only the Google account; import the person with *Sync from Google* once they start.

PART 4

Onboarding & Exits

What happens after someone joins, and when they leave: the new-joiner board, your own profile, and the exit and no-dues process.

Onboarding

`/onboarding` HR ADMIN

Onboarding is HR's board for new joiners. It tracks each person's first-weeks checklist, runs a one-time campaign to get everyone's profile complete, decides requests to change PAN or bank details, and exports the sheet payroll needs. Most of it ticks itself as the joiner completes their own page (see *My Profile*).

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	WHERE
New-joiner checklist and profile data.	Act.	HR ADMIN	People → Onboarding, `/onboarding`.

The page has four tabs: **Joiners**, **Profile completion**, **Change requests**, and **Export** (shown only to people with salary access).

Joiners

Confirm joining starts an onboarding automatically (see *Joining*). Anyone who joined by another route appears under **Joined without an onboarding** with a **Start** button.

Open onboardings lists each joiner with their progress (for example 3/7 required), a red *overdue* count, and a badge per checklist line coloured by state: Done, Open, N/A, or "Check by hand" for a line that cannot be verified automatically. Hover a badge to see its due date. Two buttons per person:

- **Complete**: greyed out until every required line is done or N/A; it names what is still blocking.
- **Cancel**: asks for a reason.

Click a name to open the person; their **Onboarding** card there shows every line. Lines tick themselves when the fact is true (profile complete, documents uploaded, policies acknowledged, LOT login linked, IT kit assigned in Snorkel, probation date set). Other lines are ticked by their owner: the joiner, IT, the manager (manager lines only) or HR, with a note where one is required. The lines themselves are edited at **Admin → Onboarding Checklist**, and the policies joiners must read at **Admin → Policies**.

Profile completion

Gets every current employee's profile filled in once. The **Campaign** card shows how many active profiles are complete. Press **Launch** and confirm: everyone with an incomplete profile then sees a **Complete your profile** banner until they finish. Joiners with an open onboarding see it already. Launching is once only.

Missing, by field counts what is missing across the company, and the **People** list shows each person's percentage done and the *labels* of what they still need (never the values). Switch between *Incomplete only* and *Everyone*.

Change requests

PAN and bank details, once filled, cannot simply be overwritten by the employee; a change becomes a request for HR to decide. **Awaiting approval** lists each request with the person, what and when, and a table of *Current* against *New*. PAN is decided on its own; the three bank fields (name, account number, IFSC) are one change, decided together. Press **Approve** (it takes effect at once) or **Reject** (you must give a reason the person will see). If the person edited the request after you loaded it, Podium reloads so you decide what they actually sent. **You never decide your own request**: another HR person does. **Recently decided** keeps the history.

Export for payroll

For people with salary access. Tick the joiners (open onboardings and recent joiners are ticked by default) and press **Download Excel**. The file has the columns of the payroll provider's "Employee Data" sheet, with account, UAN and phone numbers kept as text so leading zeros survive. Podium warns when the PF yes/no column is blank for anyone (no accepted offer carried it); fill it before uploading.

> ⚠ THE EXPORT HOLDS PAY AND BANK DATA
>
> It carries CTC, bank and past-salary figures. Each export is logged per person. Share it only with the payroll team.

My Profile

`/welcome` EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

My Profile is the page every employee, and every new joiner, uses to fill in their own details once: personal information, contact, address, bank, statutory numbers and documents. HR and payroll use what you enter here, so it is worth getting right the first time.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	WHERE
Completing and keeping your own details.	Act: you fill it in.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	My Profile, `/welcome`.

To complete your profile

Open **My Profile** (it is under Performance in the menu; a joiner with no other Podium access still sees it, and the "Complete your profile" banner links here). The top says how many items are still needed and your percentage complete. Anything missing is marked *needed*; required fields carry a *.

1. **Work down the sections. Personal** (preferred name, date of birth, gender, blood group, PAN), **Contact & emergency** (personal email, mobile, emergency contact name and mobile), **Address** (current, and permanent if different), **Bank** (name on the account, account number, IFSC) and **Statutory** (PF UAN and ESIC number, if you have them).
2. **Previous employer, only if it applies.** If you changed jobs this financial year (April to March), fill in *Previous employer this financial year*: taxable salary paid, exemptions and TDS. Only you and the payroll team can see it. Skip it otherwise.
3. **Press Save.** The button stays dim until you change something, and counts your unsaved changes. Fields that fail a check (for example a PAN not shaped like ABCDE1234F) show the problem under the box.
4. **Upload documents.** In **Documents**, the required types show as badges that turn ticked as you add them. Pick a type, choose a PDF or photo up to 15 MB and press **Upload**. Uploads are private to you and HR.
5. **Read your policies.** Under **Policies to read**, press **Read** to open each, then **I have read this** to acknowledge it. If a newer version is published, read that one.

Your first weeks

A joiner with an open onboarding also sees a **Your first weeks** card listing what happens around joining and who does it, with a count such as 3/7 done. Your own lines tick themselves as you complete this page.

Changing PAN or bank details later

Once your PAN or bank details are filled in, you cannot overwrite them directly. The field says **Changing this sends it to HR for approval**. Enter the new value and Save; it becomes a request, and a blue notice reads **Awaiting HR approval** while the current value stays in force. You can press **Withdraw** on that notice at any time. The three bank fields travel together as one change. When HR approves, the new value is applied; if they reject it, you see their reason.

> ⓘ **"YOUR LOGIN IS NOT LINKED TO AN EMPLOYEE PROFILE"**
>
> If you see this instead of the form, your sign-in has not been matched to your employee record yet. Ask HR to link it.

Exits

`/exits` EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

Exits is how Podium handles someone leaving. You start an exit with a last working day, work through a no-dues checklist that checks Snorkel and Docket live, and **Close the exit**, which is the only way a person becomes Exited. The Exits page is HR's board of everything in flight.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	BOARD
Leaving, no-dues, Google clean-up.	Act.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	People → Exits, `/exits` (HR).

To start an exit

Open the person's profile (an employee uses their own *My Performance* page; a manager can also use *Your team* card there). The **Exit** card has a button: **Resign** for yourself, **Start exit** for someone else.

1. **Reason.** Resignation, Termination, Absconding, End of internship, End of contract or Other (Other needs a note). Someone resigning for themselves is always "Resignation".
2. **Notice date.** Today for a resignation. For others it can be up to 7 days back (HR can record an older one) and never before they joined.
3. **Last working day (LWD).** Defaults to the notice date plus the notice period. Only HR can set a different date, and must say why; an LWD in an earlier month (which changes a closed payroll month) also needs a reason. HR can note whether the person is eligible for rehire, privately.
4. **Press Start exit** and confirm. The person stays **Active**, shown as **On notice**, and the checklist is built.

The no-dues checklist

The Exit card groups lines by owner (HR, Manager, IT, Admin, Finance, Store). HR can tick any line; a manager can tick only the manager lines. A line is marked **Done** or **N/A** (where allowed, with a reason) and can be **Reopened**. Some lines are checked live:

- **Assets**, from Snorkel: the assets still assigned to them are listed. If Snorkel cannot tell (no linked login), HR checks by hand and marks the line Done with a note of how.
- **Open work**, from Docket: their open tasks are listed.
- **Payment requests**, from Snorkel: open requests are listed; Finance checks by hand if they cannot be found.
- **LOT access** is done by the close itself.

The F&F line is a later phase: it is not calculated here and is not needed to close.

Closing the exit

HR sees **Close exit** and **Cancel exit** at the bottom. Under **Before it can close** Podium lists the live blockers: it is before the last working day, required lines are open, assets still assigned, open Docket tasks. Close stays greyed out until the list is empty. On close, the person becomes **Exited** on their last working day, their LOT login, Podium role and salary access end, and their direct reports move up a level. **Closing is the only way to mark someone exited**; the Google sync no longer exits anyone. **Cancel exit** (for example a withdrawn resignation) asks for a reason. After closing, HR can still add exit-interview notes and the private rehire flag.

The Exits page

Four cards, top to bottom:

`Open exits`	Everyone on notice, their reason, last working day with days left (red when past), checklist progress and what still blocks closing, or "Ready to close". Click a row for the person.
`Google accounts to action`	An exited person's Google account is **never suspended automatically**; until someone acts it still signs in and still costs a seat. A Google admin picks one of three: **Drive → manager, suspend** (hands their Drive to the manager, then suspends; use **Check transfer** if it is still running), **Suspend now** (the Drive stays with the suspended account), or **Keep until…** (a future date and a reason; it comes back as due once the date passes).
`Backfill review`	People marked exited before exits were tracked. Pick the reason, confirm the real last working day and press **Confirm**. No guessing: the date decides the month their pay stops counting toward overheads.
`Exited, still with access`	Appears only when someone exited still has a login, role, salary access, Google-admin power or assets. **Revoke access** removes the first four (logged); **Open Google item** adds them to the Google list. Nothing is revoked on its own.

> ⓘ CHECKLIST LINES ARE EDITABLE
>
> HR can change which lines exist and who owns them at **Admin → Exit Checklist**.

PART 5

Performance

Your own performance page, the team feed, and the twice-yearly appraisal cycle from self-review to acknowledgement.

My Performance

`/me` EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

My Performance is your own corner of Podium: the wins you've recorded, the observations and 1:1 notes that have been shared with you, the open action items from your meetings, and your live appraisal. Everyone has this page, even with no other access, and it always shows only your own data.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
Your record, in one place.	Act: record your own wins; take part in your appraisal.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	Always just you.

The Appraisals block

When there's a live appraisal cycle that involves you, a yellow **Appraisals** block sits at the top. It's your one-click way in, and it's how you take part without needing any special menu:

- **Your own appraisal**: "start your self-review," "self-review submitted (editable)," or "your result is ready" once HR shares it. Click through to the appraisal screen.
- **Reviews you owe**: if you manage people, anyone of yours waiting on your manager review appears here too.

If there's no active cycle, the block simply isn't shown. The full walkthrough is in *Filling In an Appraisal*.

Open action items

If your 1:1s have left you with action items that aren't done yet, they're gathered into a banner near the top, each tagged with the meeting it came from. It's a running to-do list pulled straight from your check-ins, so nothing quietly slips.

The three tabs

My Wins	Accomplishments you record about yourself. Click **Add win**, give it a title (and optional detail, a date and tags), and save. These are yours to add and edit, and they're the raw material for your self-review at appraisal time.

Shared With Me	Observations your managers (or HR) have explicitly chosen to share with you. You only ever see observations on this tier; the private and managers-only ones never appear here.
My 1:1s	Your one-to-one notes: the shared notes your manager wrote and the action items, which you can read. You can't edit a 1:1 (your manager owns it), and the manager-only private notes never show.

✓ RECORD WINS AS THEY HAPPEN

The best time to log a win is right after it lands, not the night before your self-review. A steady trickle through the year makes the appraisal write-up almost automatic, and gives your manager real examples to draw on.

ⓘ WHY YOU CAN'T SEE EVERY NOTE ABOUT YOU

“Shared With Me” shows only what was deliberately shared. Managers also keep constructive or work-in-progress observations at a more private setting while they're still forming a view. That's by design (see the Profile chapter for the visibility tiers); it isn't that something is being hidden from you unfairly, it's that not every working note is meant to be a finished message.

OKRs

/okrs EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

OKRs are how Podium tracks what we're trying to achieve each half-year and how far we've got. An **Objective** is a short, ambitious statement of intent; under it sit two to five **Key Results** — measurable checks that tell you whether the objective actually happened. They cascade from the company down to departments and individuals, run on the same twice-yearly rhythm as appraisals, and score themselves from your check-ins.

WHAT IT'S FOR	CADENCE	WHO	SCOPE
Set goals, track progress, grade the outcome.	Two cycles a year (Apr & Oct), aligned to appraisals.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	Company & dept goals are open; individual goals stay within the reporting line.

The three levels

`Company`	The handful of goals the whole business is pushing on this cycle. Set by HR/leadership. Everyone can see them.
`Department`	A team's goals, ideally aligned up to a company objective. Set by HR or the department head. Everyone can see them.
`Individual`	Your own goals for the cycle, ideally aligned up to a department or company objective. You (or your manager) set them. **Only you, your managers up the chain, and HR can see them** — not your peers.

Key results & scoring

Each key result has a **start**, a **target**, and a live **current** value — or, for a yes/no result, a simple *milestone*. Its score is how far you've moved from start to target, capped between 0% and 100%. The objective's overall progress is the weighted average of its key results.

Two numbers matter: the **auto progress** (computed continuously from your check-ins) and, at the end, the **final grade** — a score you set yourself when the cycle moves to scoring, alongside a short reflection. The auto number is shown next to it for reference. Grading is deliberately a judgment call, not just the arithmetic.

Checking in

Open any objective and, on each key result, click **Check in**: enter the new current value, pick a confidence (*On track* / *At risk* / *Off track*), and add an optional note on what moved. Every check-in is kept as history, and the progress bar updates immediately.

✓ A WEEKLY RHYTHM BEATS A SCRAMBLE

Update your key results little and often. A result that hasn't been touched in a fortnight gets a **Needs check-in** flag on your *My Performance* page and on the cycle overview — a gentle nudge, not a telling-off.

Where OKRs live

OKRs	The overview: pick a cycle, then browse company, department and individual objectives with their progress. Click any objective to open it.
My Performance	Your *My OKRs* block — your objectives with quick check-in, a button to add a new objective, and the company/department goals surfaced to you.
Team	Managers see their reports' objectives and progress, and can drill into any of them.

The cycle, start to finish (HR)

HR runs cycles from **OKRs → Manage cycles**. A cycle moves through four states:

- **Draft** — HR is building it and seeding company & department objectives; nobody else sees it yet.
- **Active** — the working window. People add key results and check in; progress is live.
- **Scoring** — end of cycle. Owners set the final grade and a reflection on each objective.
- **Closed** — read-only archive.

OKRs & appraisals

Because a cycle is anchored to an appraisal date, the individual objectives for that period show up — read-only — on the appraisal screen, so the reviewer has the goals in front of them. **They are context only and never change the rating or the increment.**

Team

/team MANAGER HR ADMIN

Team is a manager's feed of recent activity across everyone who reports to them, directly or further down the line. It's where you keep an eye on your people's wins and observations, and where you quickly log a new observation without hunting through profiles.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
Your team's recent performance activity.	Read; log observations inline.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Your whole reporting line.

Who shows up here

The feed covers your reporting chain: your direct reports and the people under them. If you don't manage anyone yet, the page says so; people appear here the moment they're set to report to you (on their profile).

Reading the feed

Each card is one piece of activity, newest first, tagged by type:

TYPE	WHAT IT SHOWS
Observation	A note logged about the person, with its tone (Positive, Neutral, Constructive).
Win	An accomplishment the person recorded about themselves.
1:1	A one-to-one's shared notes. If it's a 1:1 you're not party to, it shows as "Private 1:1" without the contents.

Click a card to jump to that person's profile. Two dropdowns at the top filter the feed: by **type** (just observations, just wins, just 1:1s) and by **person**.

Logging an observation

1. **Use the yellow "Log observation for…" dropdown** and pick the person.
2. **Write what you observed** and set its tone and its visibility (see the callout). Add a date and tags if useful.

3 **Save.** It joins their record on their profile and your feed. Close the panel with the × when you're done.

⛔ CHOOSE THE VISIBILITY DELIBERATELY

Every observation has a visibility, and it decides who ever reads it: **Private** (you and HR only), **Shared with managers** (you, the chain above the person, and HR), or **Shared with person** (also the person themselves). The person never sees the first two. Pick before you save: get it right at the moment of writing rather than relying on fixing it later.

✓ LITTLE AND OFTEN BEATS A YEAR-END SCRAMBLE

A few honest observations spread through the period make calibration and the appraisal write-up far easier, and fairer, than trying to remember everything in one sitting. The inline logger is built so you can do it in the flow of a normal week.

Appraisals (HR)

`/appraisals` HR ADMIN

Appraisals is where HR runs the twice-yearly review from start to finish: create a cycle, choose who's in it, watch progress as self-reviews and manager reviews come in, calibrate the final ratings, and share results. This chapter covers the HR view; the form everyone fills in is covered in *Filling In an Appraisal*.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	CADENCE
Running appraisal cycles.	Act: create, enroll, calibrate, share.	HR ADMIN	Twice a year: 1 Apr & 1 Oct.

How a cycle works

Cycles are anchored to an **appraisal date**, either 1 April or 1 October. That date is also when any increment takes effect. Everything else is worked out from it: the six-month review window, and the eligibility cut-off (three months before the anchor). A cycle moves through four states:

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS
Draft	Being set up. Enroll people here. No reviews accepted yet.
Active	Open for self-reviews and manager reviews.
Calibration	Reviews locked; HR sets the final ratings and shares results.
Closed	Done and read-only.

Creating and enrolling

1. **New cycle.** Pick the appraisal date (1 Apr / 1 Oct) and an optional name like "H2 2026." The window and cut-off fill in themselves.
2. **Enroll people.** Open enrollment to see everyone with their eligibility worked out for you. **Eligible** means they joined before the cut-off; borderline and missing-join-date cases are flagged for your judgement. Tick who's in and enroll them.
3. **Activate.** Move the cycle to Active to open reviews. People now see their self-review on My Performance, and managers see the reviews they owe.

ⓘ CATCH-UP PERIODS ARE AUTOMATIC

Each person's review window runs from their *last* appraisal (or their joining date if it's their first) up to the anchor. So someone who joined mid-period, or missed a cycle, automatically gets a longer first window rather than being short-changed. Their increment is pro-rated to match.

The cycle dashboard

Opening a cycle shows progress tiles, **Enrolled, Self done, Mgr done, Finalized, Shared, Acknowledged** and a **PIP** count, so you can see at a glance where the cohort is. Below them is the calibration grid: one row per person showing their self rating, their manager's rating, the final rating, an HR-only note, and a suggested increment percentage.

Calibrating and sharing

1. **Move the cycle to Calibration** when reviews are in. This locks further editing of the reviews.
2. **Set each final rating** in the grid (1–5) and add an optional calibration note. The note is HR-internal and never shown to the employee. Click Finalize.
3. **Share results.** Use **Share all finalized** to release every finalized result at once, or share one at a time from a person's appraisal. Only then can the employee see their rating.
4. **Close the cycle** when everyone's done.

⛔ NOTHING REACHES THE EMPLOYEE UNTIL YOU SHARE

Self-ratings, manager ratings, your calibration note and the final rating all stay hidden from the employee until the moment you share. The employee never sees the manager's raw rating or your note, only the final rating and the manager's written feedback. Share deliberately, and only once a result is genuinely finalized.

⚠ A LOW FINAL RATING TRIGGERS A PIP

If a final rating falls at or below the threshold (2 by default), the appraisal is flagged as a Performance Improvement Plan and counted on the PIP tile. That's a deliberate, visible outcome, so set final ratings with care.

Filling In an Appraisal

`/appraisals/detail` EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN

This is the single appraisal screen everyone uses, but it shows you a different face depending on who you are to it: the person being appraised, their manager, or HR. You reach it from the link on My Performance (for your own or one you owe) or from the cycle grid (for HR). It shows you exactly the part you need to fill in, and hides the rest until it's meant to be seen.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCALE
One person's appraisal, end to end.	Act: write, rate, calibrate, acknowledge.	EMPLOYEE MANAGER HR ADMIN	1–5 plus three written prompts.

The flow, in order

An appraisal moves through clear stages, each unlocking the next: **self-review → manager review → HR calibration → shared with you → acknowledged**. You only ever act on the stage that's yours.

If it's your appraisal EMPLOYEE

1. **Give yourself an overall rating** from 1 to 5, using the rating buttons.
2. **Answer the three prompts** in writing: what went well, what could have gone better, and your focus for the next period.
3. **Rate your KPIs** if your role has them (optional).
4. **Submit.** You can keep editing while the cycle is open; submitting also lets your manager start their review.

Once HR shares the result, this screen shows **Your result**: your final rating, your manager's written feedback, and any increment. You can optionally **acknowledge** it with a note, and open a printable letter.

If you're the manager MANAGER

You see the person's submitted self-review first, then your own form: an overall rating, the same three prompts, and optional per-KPI ratings. Submit when ready; like the self-review, it stays editable while the cycle is open. You do not set the final rating, that's HR's calibration step, and you won't see the final number until it's finalized.

ⓘ THE THREE PROMPTS

Every review, self and manager, answers the same three questions: **what went well**, **what could have gone better**, and the **focus for the next period**. Keeping the prompts identical on both sides makes the two views easy to compare side by side at calibration.

If you're HR HR

You see both reviews in full, then the **calibration** panel:

1. **Set the final rating** (1–5) and an optional calibration note. The note is HR-internal and never shown to the employee. Click Finalize.
2. **Record the increment** if you have compensation access: an increment percentage and/or a one-time bonus. The effective date defaults to the cycle's anchor, and the suggested percentage comes from the rating band.
3. **Share with the employee.** Until you do, they see nothing.
4. **Print the letters.** An appraisal letter, and an increment letter where there's a revision, open as clean printable pages you can save as PDF.

⛔ THE CALIBRATION NOTE STAYS WITH HR

The calibration note is for HR's own record only. It is never shown to the employee or the manager, even after sharing. Use it for context behind a decision; never put anything in it you'd be uncomfortable keeping internal.

ⓘ INCREMENTS WHILE THE VAULT IS OFF

With the salary vault disabled (the current default), an increment records the **percentage and any bonus amount**, not an absolute salary. The increment letter states the revision in those terms. Absolute figures only come into play once the vault is switched on, after the extra security layer is live (see *Settings*).

Analytics

`/analytics` HR ADMIN

Analytics is the numbers view of Podium: how the team is growing, what it costs, and how performance is trending. Everything on this page is a total or an average: it never shows any individual person's pay or rating.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	EXTRA GATE
Org, cost & performance trends.	Read-only.	HR ADMIN	Payroll Cost: salary allow-list only.

The three sections

SECTION	WHAT IT SHOWS
Org & Headcount	Headcount by department and type, joiners vs exits by month, how long people have been here, and the attrition rate.
Payroll Cost	Total annual CTC and the monthly cost it implies, cost by department, salary spread, and a plan-vs-actuals trend that fills in as real payouts are recorded. Only visible to the salary allow-list.
Performance	Rating spread and participation for recent appraisal cycles, PIP count, and how actively observations, wins and 1:1s are being logged.

ⓘ AGGREGATES ONLY

The Payroll Cost section is department totals and averages. To see a specific person's pay you still go to their profile, and that stays limited to the salary allow-list, with every view logged.

ⓘ EMPTY CHARTS ARE NORMAL AT FIRST

Cycle charts appear after the first appraisal cycle runs, and the "actuals" series fills in as payouts are recorded (automatically once the payroll connector is live). An empty chart means no data yet, not a fault.

PART 6

Org Design

The role and KPI registry and the department structure that the org chart and appraisals are built on.

Roles & KPIs

/roles MANAGER HR ADMIN

Roles & KPIs is the registry of job roles at Legend of Toys: each role's title, level, job description, the responsibilities it carries, the KPIs it's measured on, and (for those with compensation access) its salary band. People are then assigned to a role on their profile, and the role's KPIs flow into their appraisal.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	FEEDS
Defining job roles and their KPIs.	Read; HR edits; bands need comp access.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Profiles & appraisal KPIs.

The role list

The main screen lists every role with its title, code, level, department, KPI count and (if you have compensation access) the mid-point of its salary band. A locked padlock in the band column means the bands exist but you don't have access to see them. Click a row to open the role.

A role's detail

Each role has two halves:

Job Definition	Title, code, level, department, a short summary, the full job description, and a list of responsibilities (one per line). HR edits these; everyone else reads them.
KPIs	The measures this role is judged on. Each KPI has a name, description, a type (quantitative or qualitative), a target and a weight. These are what appear, per person, in the appraisal.
Salary band	Minimum, mid and maximum for the role. Visible and editable only with compensation access; hidden behind a padlock for everyone else.
People in this role	Everyone currently assigned to the role, each a link to their profile.

Creating and editing (HR)

1. **New Role** on the list: enter a title (and optional code and level) to create it, then you land on its detail to flesh it out.
2. **Fill in the definition** and click **Save definition**. Mark a role **inactive** rather than deleting it when it's no longer in use.
3. **Add KPIs** with **Add KPI**, fill in each one, then **Save KPIs** (the definition and the KPIs save separately).

✓ GOOD KPIS MAKE BETTER APPRAISALS

Because a role's KPIs are exactly what both the employee and the manager rate at appraisal time, time spent here pays off later. Clear names, a real target and sensible weights turn a vague review into a specific one.

ⓘ WHY A BAND MIGHT SHOW A PADLOCK

Salary bands sit behind the separate compensation permission, just like pay on a profile. If you can manage roles but see a padlock on the bands, that's expected: an admin can grant compensation access if you need it.

Departments

`/departments` MANAGER HR ADMIN

Departments is the list of teams at Legend of Toys, each with a head, an optional parent department, and a live headcount. It's the structure the directory filters by, the dashboard counts by, and that profiles and roles attach to.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	FEEDS
Defining the team structure.	Read; HR adds & edits.	MANAGER HR ADMIN	Directory, dashboard, profiles.

The list

Each row shows the department's name, code, its head, its parent department (if it sits under another), and its current headcount. The headcount updates as people are assigned to or moved off the department on their profiles.

Adding or editing (HR)

1. **New Department** (or the pencil to edit one) opens a small form.
2. **Set the name** (the only required field), and optionally a code, a **head** (chosen from people), a **parent department** and a description.
3. **Use the Active toggle** to retire a department without deleting it.
4. **Save.**

> ⓘ PARENT DEPARTMENT VS REPORTING LINE
>
> The **parent department** nests teams for grouping (for example a Store team under Production). It is not the same as the org chart's reporting lines, which come from each *person's* manager, not from their department. The two can look similar but are set in different places.

> ✓ SET A HEAD WHERE YOU CAN
>
> Naming a department head keeps the structure legible and gives the org chart and reports a clear owner per team. It's optional, but a department with no head is easy to lose track of.

PART 7

Administration

Who can see and do what in Podium, and the system-wide settings.

Roles & Permissions

`/admin/roles` ADMIN

Roles & Permissions is where an admin defines what people can do in Podium. Podium runs its own set of roles, separate from every other LOT system, built from four simple permissions. You create as many named roles as you like from those permissions, then hand them out on the Users screen.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
Defining Podium access roles.	Act: create & edit roles.	ADMIN	Podium only, not other systems.

The four permissions

PERMISSION	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
View	The directory, org chart and dashboards. The baseline for seeing anyone beyond yourself.
People (HR)	Manage people, departments, roles, documents and org snapshots, and run appraisal cycles.
Compensation	See and edit pay: increments, bonuses and salary bands. Kept separate so it can be granted on its own.
Admin	Manage these roles, assign people to them, and change settings.

Creating a role

1. **New Role.** Give it a key (a short code like `hr_lead`), a readable label and an optional description.
2. **Flip on the permissions** it should carry. A role with none of them is a perfectly valid "self-only" role.
3. **Save**, then assign people to it on the Users screen.

⚠ ANY HIGHER PERMISSION SWITCHES VIEW ON FOR YOU

If you turn on People, Compensation or Admin, the **View** permission is switched on and locked automatically. That's deliberate: those jobs all need to see people in the first place, so a role can't accidentally be created that locks itself out of the screens it's meant to use.

System roles

Two roles come built in and can't be reshaped: **Admin** (everything) and **Employee** (the empty, self-only default). You can rename their label and description, but not their permissions, and you can't delete them. A handful of ready-made roles (an HR preset, a compensation preset, a people-manager preset) are also provided to copy or use as-is.

> **PODIUM ROLES DON'T TOUCH OTHER SYSTEMS**
>
> Giving someone the HR or Admin role here changes only their People & Performance access. It does **not** change anything they can do in Garage, Redline or any other LOT system; those are governed separately. This isolation is the whole reason Podium has its own roles. A role with people assigned to it also can't be deleted, so reassign first.

Users

/admin/users ADMIN

Users is where an admin hands out Podium roles. Every LOT person with a login appears in one list; you pick a Podium role for each. Anyone left without a role gets self-only access, which is a real, working level, just their own profile and wins.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	DEFAULT
Assigning a Podium role to each person.	Act: set one role per person.	ADMIN	No role = self-only.

Reading the list

Each row is a person with a login: their name, email, their current Podium role (or "self-only (default)" if none), and a dropdown to change it. A search box up top filters by name, email or role.

Assigning a role

1. **Find the person** with the search box.
2. **Pick a role** from their dropdown. The list is the roles you defined on Roles & Permissions.
3. **That's it.** The change saves immediately. To remove someone's access back to baseline, choose **— none (self-only) —**.

> ⓘ ACCOUNTS COME FROM GARAGE; THIS ONLY SETS PEOPLE ACCESS
>
> You don't create logins here; LOT accounts are made in Garage. The Users screen only decides what a person can do in *Podium*. So a brand-new joiner has a login as soon as Garage sets it up, and self-only access in Podium until you give them a wider role.

> ⚠ ONE PODIUM ROLE PER PERSON
>
> Each person has exactly one Podium role at a time, so picking a new one replaces the old. If someone needs an unusual mix of access, the answer is to define a role with that mix on Roles & Permissions and assign it, rather than trying to stack roles.

✓ MANAGER ACCESS DOESN'T NEED A ROLE

Remember that seeing your team comes from the org chart, not from a role here. You don't need to assign anyone a “manager” role for them to see their reports; just make sure people's managers are set on their profiles. Roles here are for the wider tiers: HR, compensation and admin.

Settings

`/admin/settings` ADMIN

Settings holds the handful of system-wide switches that change how Podium behaves for everyone: the salary vault, the appraisal eligibility rule, and the shortcuts into the permission screens. It's a short page, but a couple of its switches are consequential.

WHAT IT'S FOR	READ OR ACT?	WHO	SCOPE
System-wide settings.	Act: a few global toggles.	ADMIN	The whole of Podium.

Salary Vault

This switch decides whether Podium stores **absolute salary figures** at all. While it's **off** (the default), Podium records only increment percentages and one-time bonus amounts; full base-salary and CTC figures are never kept. Turning it on lets those figures be stored and shown to people with compensation access.

> **LEAVE THE VAULT OFF UNTIL THE SECURITY LAYER IS LIVE**
>
> Company-wide standing pay is the most sensitive data we hold, so the vault is meant to stay off until an extra sign-in wall (a network-level access layer in front of the whole site) is in place. Do not switch it on as a convenience: turning it on early would store full salaries before that protection exists. Until then, percentages and bonuses cover what appraisals need.

Appraisal Eligibility

A single number: the minimum tenure, in days, before someone counts as eligible for an appraisal. It sets the bar that the enrollment screen uses when it works out who's eligible for a cycle. Edit the number and click away to save.

Permissions

A reminder that Podium runs its own permissions, with quick links to **Roles & Permissions** (define roles) and **Users** (assign them). Anyone with no role assigned gets self-only access. See those two chapters for the detail.

ⓘ THESE SETTINGS RIPPLE OUTWARD

Unlike a personal preference, a switch here changes Podium for everyone. The eligibility number shapes who's offered in the next cycle; the vault setting changes what every compensation screen will store and show. Change them with that reach in mind.